Where tesoro stands

An autonomous economic governance layer, assessed against the 2026 stablecoin compliance landscape: seven regulatory frameworks, six kinds of obliged entity, and the actor none of them name.

Prepared 2026-08-22 · Landscape from *Stablecoin compliance in 2026: which rules apply to your business*, Sumsub, 66pp · Measurements from sealed research records EXP-007 to EXP-010 · **Not legal advice, and not a claim of regulatory compliance.**

THE FINDING, IN ONE PARAGRAPH

None of the six business segments in the compliance landscape is *an autonomous agent that spends*. That is correct rather than an omission: an agent has no legal personality, cannot hold a licence and cannot be a VASP, so no framework attaches to it. **The exposure lands on the obliged entity instead, and it arrives without a category.** Three assumptions the frameworks rest on break at once, and what closes the gap is not screening or identity — it is evidence of which human authority an agent acted under, and which control permitted the payment.

1 · The landscape

Seven frameworks account for most stablecoin obligations in 2026. None operates in isolation, and the guide's own conclusion is the useful frame: *a single stablecoin payment can involve several of them at once.*

FRAMEWORK	SCOPE	WHAT IT PRINCIPALLY BINDS
FATF R.16 (Travel Rule)	global	Originator and beneficiary information on qualifying virtual-asset transfers, in both directions
GENIUS Act	United States	Permitted Payment Stablecoin Issuers: reserves, redemption, and a risk-based AML/CFT and sanctions programme
MiCA	European Union	EMT and ART issuers, and CASPs serving EU clients
FCA regime	United Kingdom	Authorisation before regulated activity; issuers, custodians, platforms
MAS framework	Singapore	Single-currency stablecoins; reserves, attestation, redemption windows
HKMA Ordinance	Hong Kong	Licensed issuance, capital and reserve backing
VARA	Dubai / UAE	Prior approval for fiat-referenced virtual asset issuance

The obligations are then allocated by **what a business does**: banks adding stablecoin activity, issuers, payments and processors, infrastructure and custody, wallets, and card issuers. Each has its own readiness checklist.

ONE TIMELINE WORTH BEING EXACT ABOUT

The GENIUS Act was signed **18 July 2025**; implementing regulations were due **18 July 2026**; the framework takes effect **18 January 2027** or 120 days after final rules. FinCEN and OFAC published a joint proposed AML/CFT rule on **10 April 2026**, proposed to take effect twelve months after issuance. These obligations fall on *issuers* — a point §5 returns to, because it decides what this software can honestly be.

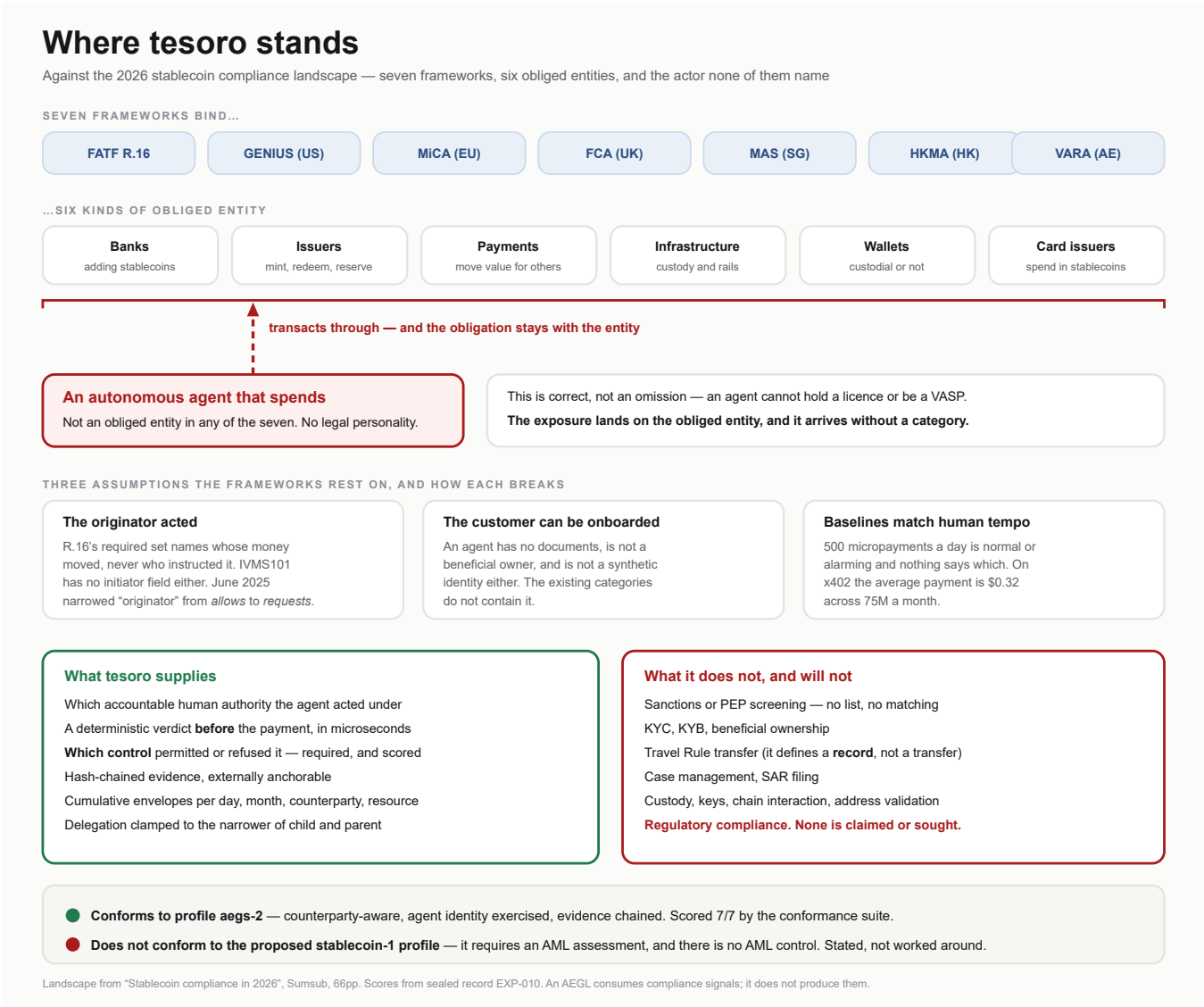


Figure 1. Seven frameworks bind six kinds of obliged entity. An agent is outside all of them, yet transacts through them — and the obligation stays with the entity.

2 · Three assumptions that break

2.1 The originator is a person who acted

FATF R.16 requires originator and beneficiary information on qualifying transfers. An agent-initiated payment *has* an originator — the party whose funds move — and that party **did not initiate the transfer**. They authorised a policy, days earlier, under which software later decided.

The required set under INR.16 ¶9 is name, account number or unique transaction reference, address or national identity number or customer identification number or date and place of birth, and an LEI or BIC for legal persons. **Every element identifies whose money moved. None identifies who instructed the movement, or on what authority.** So it cannot distinguish three materially different situations: a person who reviewed and sent the payment; a person who delegated authority to an agent that sent it under policy; and a person whose credentials an agent used after being compromised.

CHECKED AGAINST THE SOURCE TEXT, 2026-08-28

The June 2025 revision moved *away* from delegated authority. FATF changed the glossary definition of *originator* from the account holder who **allows** the transfer to the account holder who **requests** it. "Allows" would have covered someone who authorised a standing policy; "requests" does not. The phrase *artificial intelligence* appears nowhere in the explanatory note, so this is a consequence of the change and not its intent.

The check also **refuted a broader claim an earlier draft made.** Fiat rails do carry an initiator field: CBPR+ `pacs.008.001.08` defines `InitiatingParty` `[0..1]` and `UltimateDebtor` `[0..1]`. It is optional, absent from R.16's required set, names a *party* and never a mode, cannot name an agent — an agent has no legal personality — and yields the same value whether authority was delegated or credentials were stolen.

On the rail this document is about there is no concession to make. IVMS101, the payload VASPs use for virtual-asset transfers, defines the originator as `originatorPersons` plus `accountNumber` and has no initiating-party, on-behalf-of, agent or delegated-authority field at all.

2.2 The customer can be onboarded

KYC, KYB, beneficial ownership and ongoing monitoring all assume a subject with documents. **An agent has no documents.** It is not a customer, not a beneficial owner, and not a synthetic identity either — a synthetic identity is a fabricated person, and an agent is not pretending to be one. The existing categories do not contain it.

What *can* be established is **attribution**: which onboarded human or entity is accountable for this agent's spending, provable afterwards. That is a governance question rather than an identity one, and it is the honest division of labour.

2.3 Monitoring baselines match human tempo

Transaction monitoring, structuring detection and velocity rules are calibrated on how people spend. An agent making **500 micropayments a day** is either entirely normal or a serious alarm, and nothing in the transaction stream says which.

The scale is measured, not hypothetical: on 21 August 2026 the x402 protocol reported **75.41 million transactions and $24.24 million of volume over 30 days** — a **$0.32 average payment** — on a protocol

whose own documentation specifies no buyer-side authorisation, no identity and no AML. On any human-calibrated model that flow is either invisible or pathological. Both readings are wrong.

3 · What actually closes the gap

WHAT AN OBLIGED ENTITY MUST BE ABLE TO SHOW	WHAT AN ECONOMIC GOVERNANCE LAYER SUPPLIES
Which accountable human authority a payment was made under	Registered identity with a delegation chain, **clamped** so a delegate's authority is the narrower of its own and its delegator's — and a delegate declaring no limit inherits its parent's rather than escaping it
That the payment was permitted *before* it happened	A deterministic pre-execution verdict. Median ~170 µs across ten runs, range 139–330 µs, zero tokens (EXP-007)
Which control permitted or refused it	The attributed control — a required output, independently scored by the conformance suite, with a declared precedence for dispositive controls
That the record has not been edited, reordered or truncated	Append-only hash-chained evidence, externally anchorable, with the residual stated rather than hidden
That cumulative exposure is bounded	Envelopes per day, month, counterparty and resource — by value *and* by action count
Whether screening ran	**Not supplied. See §5.**

THE LINE THAT HAS TO HOLD

An economic governance layer **consumes compliance signals and produces governance evidence**. It does not produce compliance signals, and it is not a compliance programme. Screening, lists, KYC/KYB, case management and filing belong to the compliance platform. Which authority an agent acted under, and which control decided, belong to the governance layer. Neither substitutes for the other.

4 · Evidence of the controls working, and of them failing

An eighteen-attack adversarial benchmark is run against the implementation on every commit, and scored against a recorded baseline that fails the build in *both* directions — a regressed defence is a vulnerability, and a closed gap is a claim four documents would need to stop making.

OUTCOME	COUNT	MEANING
`DEFENDED`	**15**	Refused, and by the control the attack targets
`DEFENDED_BY_ACCIDENT`	**1**	Refused by *something else*. Counted as a finding, not a pass — paced differently it succeeds
`UNDEFENDED`	**2**	It worked. Both are published rather than footnoted
`ERROR`	**0**	Asserted, not observed — a suite of errors reads as a clean run

OPEN: MICROTRANSACTION STRUCTURING

Forty payments of $0.001 five minutes apart. $0.04 moves, nothing refused. A count envelope *bounds* the mechanism — 2,328 actions a day is now impossible — and does not refuse this instance, because forty trivial purchases is also what a legitimate agent does.

OPEN: JOURNAL TRUNCATION

Any prefix of a valid hash chain is a valid hash chain, so a refused agent can delete the refusal. External anchoring closes it; **no anchor ships by default**, so the benchmark reports the unanchored posture.

A MEASUREMENT THAT WAS WRONG, AND HOW IT WAS CORRECTED

An earlier sealed record described the paced-evasion attack as “paced exactly at the rate limit”. It was paced *above* the limit and stopped after ten minutes, before the hourly counter could reach anything — the rate limit had worked the whole time. A superseding record carries the correction and **the original stands with its error**, because a record that can be revised after the fact stops being evidence.

5 · Where this stands, precisely

CONFORMS — PROFILE AEGS-2

Counterparty-aware governance. Agent identity exercised, budget envelopes exercised, policy identified by content hash, attributed control required, evidence chained. Scored **7/7** by the conformance suite, which imports no implementation.

DOES NOT CONFORM — PROPOSED PROFILE STABLECOIN-1

The profile requires an AML assessment to be recorded. **There is no AML control** — no list, no matching, no jurisdiction model. The implementation declares the profile it *does* meet and says why.

A MISTAKE WORTH PUBLISHING

Designing that profile, the obvious move was to emit an AML assessment reading `assessed: false` — the record would finally *say* screening had not run rather than being silent. It reads as honest and it is a false statement: `assessed: false` means *this control exists and did not run this time*, and there is no AML control at all. The truthful representation of a control an implementation lacks is the field's **absence**.

An existing guard caught it within a minute, with the reasoning already written down: *"reporting `aml: {score: 0}` would claim a clean screening that never happened."* The change was reverted. **The conclusion inverts and the honest version is stronger:** the profile keeps the requirement, and the reference implementation does not yet clear it. A profile is a bar, not a description of what happened to be built.

The remaining gaps, in priority order

GAP	STATUS	NOTE
No AML control of any kind	**blocks stablecoin-1**	Not fixable by editing the record. Needs a provider integrated behind the existing `sanctions` control — which is already the highest-precedence dispositive control, so there is somewhere for it to land
Jurisdiction is not a policy fact	open	The AML schema already carries a `jurisdiction` field; nothing populates it and nothing can rule on it. It must be *declared* data, never inferred about a counterparty
No Travel Rule originator or beneficiary fields	open	The standard should define the **record**, never the transfer. Schema-ready is honest; implementing R.16 is not this layer's job
Attribution is not framed as *originator* attribution	open	The capability exists — identity, delegation chain, clamp. The framing does not, and the framing is what makes it legible to a compliance team

6 · What is not claimed

EXPLICITLY OUTSIDE SCOPE

- **Regulatory compliance.** GENIUS obligations fall on Permitted Payment Stablecoin Issuers, MiCA's on EMT/ART issuers and CASPs, the Travel Rule's on VASPs. This is a software library and none of those.
- **AML or sanctions screening.** No list, no matching, no jurisdiction model.
- **KYC, KYB or beneficial ownership.** The opposite — these are consumed as signals.
- **Travel Rule compliance.** A record shape is not a transfer protocol.
- **Tamper-proof evidence.** The specification forbids the claim, and the prohibition does not relax because an anchor exists. Truncation is detectable *beyond the anchor's last publication*, not detectable.
- **Custody, keys, chain interaction or address validation.** No funds are held and no money is moved.
- **Independent validation.** Every conformance case and adversarial attack was written by the author of the system under test. This is the single largest limitation of the work and it cannot be closed by effort.

7 · Confidence, and what is unverified

Marked per claim, because a document of this kind is worth exactly as much as its weakest sourced sentence.

CONFIDENCE	CLAIMS
Verified	The seven frameworks, six segments and checklists, read from the source guide. The GENIUS Act timeline, confirmed independently of it. x402 volumes, from the protocol's own site on 2026-08-21. All benchmark and latency figures, from sealed records with checksums. The absent AML field, measured from a live decision record.
Verified on re-check	That R.16's *required* data set has no representation for delegated or autonomous initiation — checked 2026-08-28 against the consolidated FATF Recommendations 2012–2025 and the June 2025 explanatory note. **The check refuted the broader claim an earlier draft made** and §2.1 was rewritten: fiat `pacs.008` does carry an optional `InitgPty`. It also found the "allows" → "requests" narrowing, which is stronger than what it replaced.
Open	Whether any *jurisdiction's implementation* of R.16 adds an initiator field beyond the FATF minimum — the FATF text was read, seven national frameworks were not. Whether any regulator has published guidance on agent-initiated transfers. MiCA, FCA, MAS, HKMA and VARA specifics are as the source guide states them, not independently verified.

Landscape sourced from *Stablecoin compliance in 2026: which rules apply to your business*, Sumsub — credited as the publisher of the framework and segment analysis used in §1. Measurements from sealed research records EXP-007, EXP-009 and EXP-010, each verifiable by checksum. **This document is for general information. It is not legal advice and does not assert compliance with any framework named in it.** Prepared by Jayzilva, 2026-08-22.